belief that the nation's integrity was in danger from proponents of Khalistan who were conspiring against the state, with or without the support of foreign elements. The combined impact of the above-mentioned factors was bound to create a mood of vengeance amongst Hindus, leading to demands for strongest possible action to protect national integrity and the interests of the majority community from anti-national, divisive, communal and criminal forces bent on disturbing the peace, harmony and unity of the nation.

On the other hand it was also important to keep the pot boiling in Punjab and to allow Bhindranwale to operate unhindered till the situation was ripe for final action, it was essential to initiate dialogue with the moderate Akali Dal leaders and give them the impression that Prime Minister Gandhi was sympathetic to the resolution of their demands, for which they had been agitating for some time. But in actual fact, the talks would be prolonged on one pretext or the other, because if the demands were accepted, normalcy would return prematurely to Punjab. That would leave no scope for Bhindranwale to operate. Also, if moderate Akali leaders somehow lost all hopes of a solution and decided to suspend or withdraw their agitation before the time chosen by the 1 Akbar Road group, Bhindanwale would have been left with little justification to stay put in the Golden Temple complex. He would have come under pressure from all sides to vacate the premises and go back to his Mehta Chowk gurudwara. That was also not acceptable to the 1 Akbar Road group.

With the Opposition parties left twiddling their thumbs and compelled to endorse public demands for strong action and the 1 Akbar Road group having highjacked the agendas of some of these parties, suitable conditions would have been created for Indira Gandhi to take strong action to put an end to the above-mentioned anti-Hindu and anti-national activities of Sikh extremists and emerge as a strong, decisive leader. The only problem in this plan was that such an action had to be well timed keeping in view the next national elections, as any significant lapse of time between the two might fritter away the political gains arising out of it.